26. The Indus river originates from a glacier near Bokhar Chu in the Tibetan region in the Kailash Mansarovar range near the Mansarovar Lake. In Tibet it is known as *'Singi Khamban* or Lion's mouth.

The Indus river follows a long and straight course in Ladakh, running between the Ladakh and the Zaskar ranges.

It forms a gorge near Gilgit in Jammu and Kashmir. After crossing the Himalayas, it turns into south-west and enters Pakistan near Chillar in the Dardistan region. It flows roughly southwards until it drains into the Arabian Sea near Karachi after forming a huge delta.

Indus River System of the Zaskar river, Suru river, Soan river, Jhelum river, Chenab river, Ravi river, Beas river, Satluj river, Panjnad river as its major left-bank tributaries. The Shyok river, Gilgit river, Hunza river, Swat river, Kunnar river, Kurram river and Kabul river are its major right-bank tributaries.

27. These forests are found in the western slope of the Western Ghats, hills of the northeastern region and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. They are found in warm and humid areas with an annual precipitation of over 200 cm and mean annual temperature above 22°C.

The tropical evergreen forests usually occur in areas receiving more than 200 cm of rainfall and having a temperature of 15 to 30 degrees Celsius. They occupy about seven per cent of the earth's land surface and habours more than half of the world's plants and animals. They are found mostly near the equator.

Rainforest these forests are dense and multi-layered. They harbour many types of plants and animals. The trees are evergreen as there is no period of drought. They are mostly tall and hardwood type. Leaves are broad and give out excess water through evapo-transpiration.

In India, evergreen forests are found in the western slopes of the Western Ghats in States such as Kerala and Karnataka. They are also found in hills of Jaintia and Khasi. Some of the trees found in Indian Tropical Forests are rosewood, mahagony and ebony. Bamboos and reeds are also common.